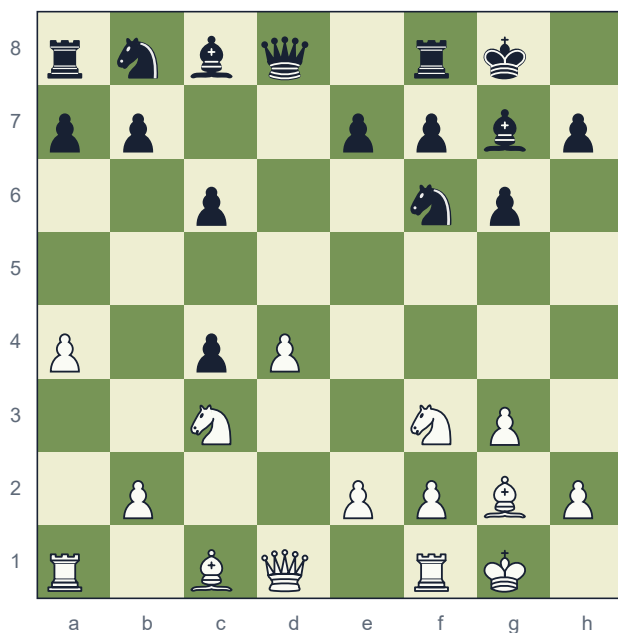


Grunfeld: keep the fianchetto

1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nf3 d5 4.g3

YOUR REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Meet the early ...d5 with the same fianchetto family used against the King's Indian. Do not mix this system with the sharp Exchange Grunfeld unless you deliberately choose that extra theory.



Main-line anchor - Black to move

THE PAWN STRUCTURE

Black challenges d4 immediately and often exchanges on c4 or d4. The long diagonals and the c- and d-files become important.

WHAT BLACK WANTS

Black wants active pieces, ...c5, and pressure against a central pawn that White advances too far. Capturing c4 can buy time for development.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. The difference between ...d6 and ...d5 is fundamental.
2. Do not play e4 by habit while d4 is under pressure.
3. Recover c4 with a plan that accounts for ...a6 and ...b5.

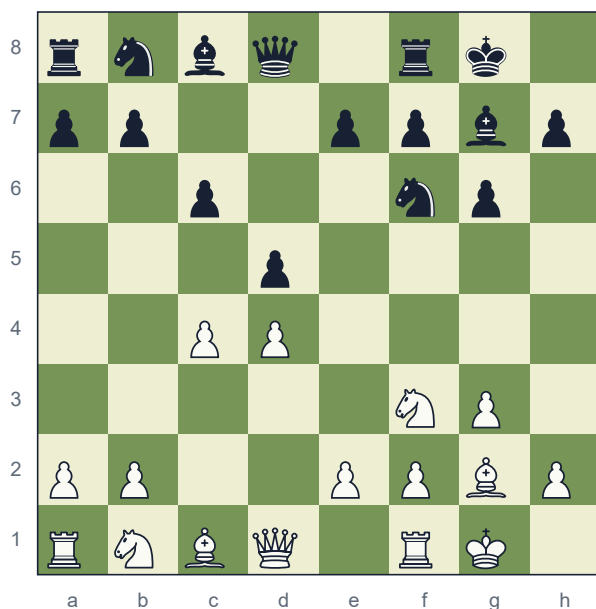
Line pages contain a selected opening anchor plus an illustrative checked continuation. They are not a forced script. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Closed fianchetto structure

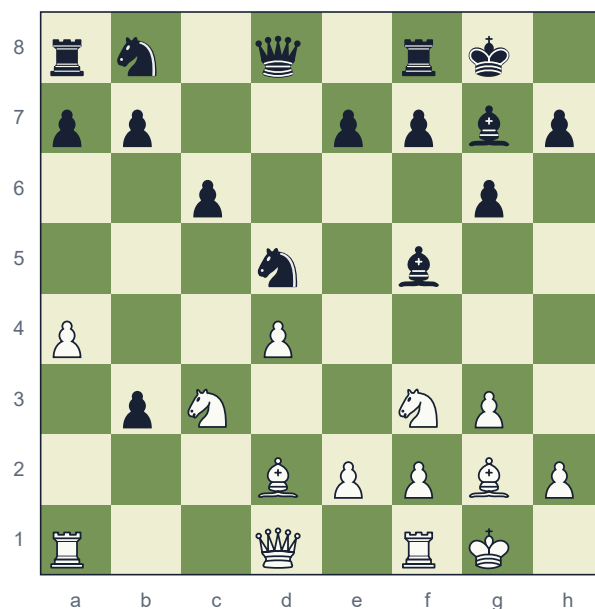
STUDY LINE 15-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 d5 4. g3 Bg7 5. Bg2 O-O 6. O-O c6 7. Nc3 dxc4 8. a4 Nd5 9. Bd2 Bf5 10. b3 cxb3

Selected anchor ends with 8. a4. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 6 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

a4 restrains ...b5 and prepares to recover the pawn without allowing a lasting queenside chain.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop e3 or a queen move to recover c4 as appropriate. Keep your pieces coordinated against ...c5 or ...Na6-b4.

WATCH FOR

The bishop on g7 can attack d4 once the diagonal opens; do not remove central defenders casually.

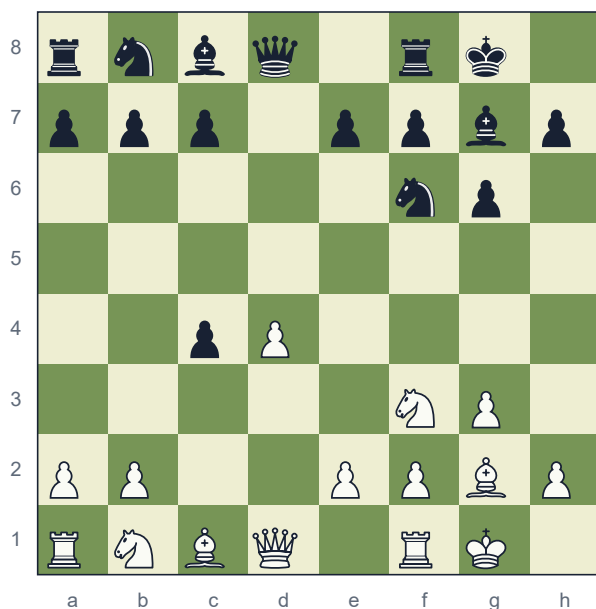
REMEMBER Secure the center while recovering the pawn.

02 Open fianchetto: ...dxc4

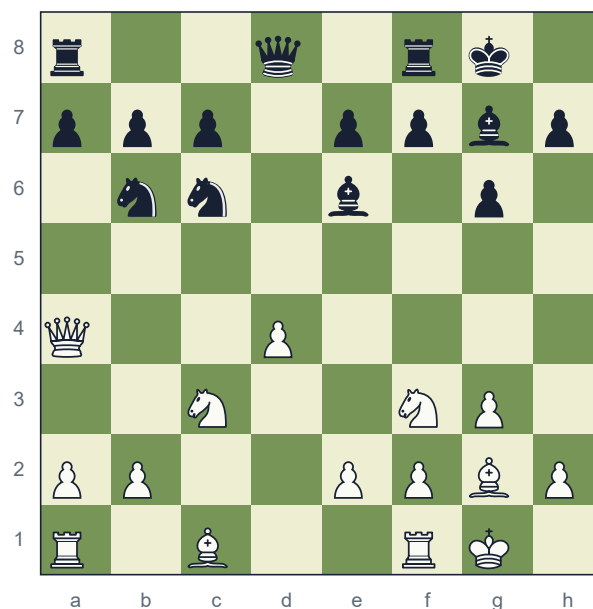
STUDY LINE 15-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 d5 4. g3 Bg7 5. Bg2 O-O 6. O-O dxc4 7. Qc2 Nc6 8. Qxc4 Be6 9. Qa4 Nd5 10. Nc3 Nb6

Selected anchor ends with 7. Qc2. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 6 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Qc2 eyes c4 and keeps the center supported. Black must decide how much effort to spend holding the extra pawn.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Recover with the queen when safe, develop the b1 knight, and meet ...c5 through central exchanges or support.

WATCH FOR

A queen capture on c4 can be met with ...b5 or ...Be6, so count the tempi before taking.

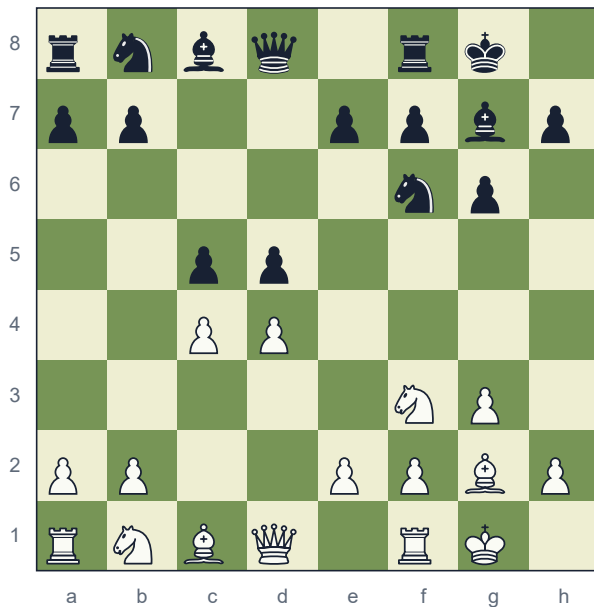
REMEMBER Recover c4 without letting the queen become a target.

03 Black plays ...c5 quickly

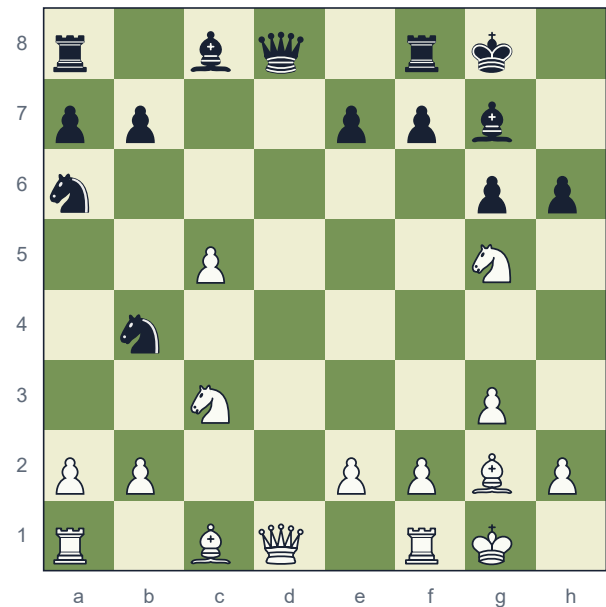
STUDY LINE 15-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 d5 4. g3 Bg7 5. Bg2 O-O 6. O-O c5 7. cxd5 Nxd5 8. dxc5 Na6 9. Ng5 Ndb4 10. Nc3 h6

Selected anchor ends with 8. dxc5. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 6 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Both central pawn pairs can be exchanged. The result emphasizes development and active files rather than a permanent space advantage.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Bring the b1 knight into play and develop the c1 bishop. Use the open center instead of trying to recreate a pawn chain that no longer exists.

WATCH FOR

A central knight may be tactically vulnerable to a queen or bishop move; check before defending a pawn with another pawn.

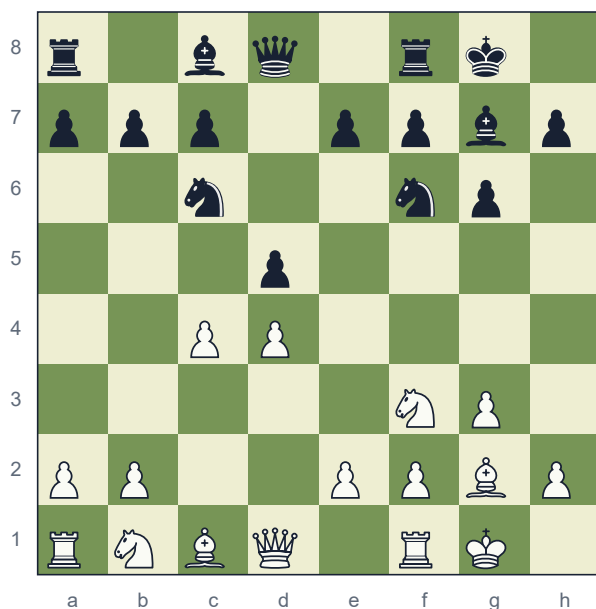
REMEMBER When the center clears, activate pieces.

04 Black develops ...Nc6

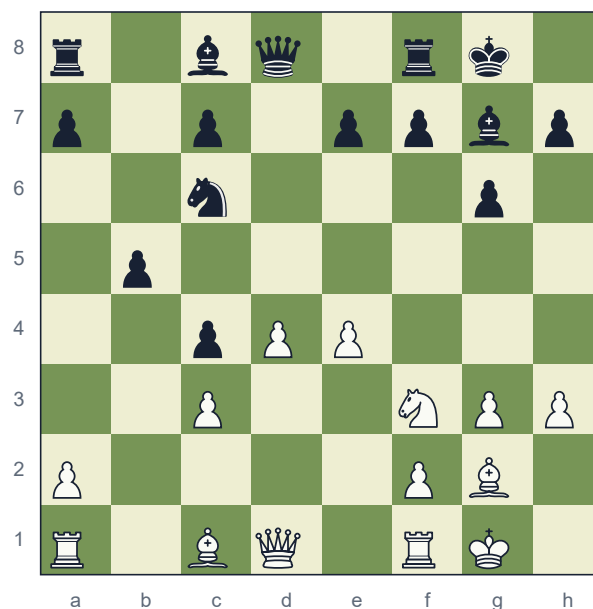
STUDY LINE 15-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 d5 4. g3 Bg7 5. Bg2 O-O 6. O-O Nc6 7. Nc3 dxc4 8. h3 Nd5 9. e4 Nxc3 10. bxc3 b5

Selected anchor ends with 7. Nc3. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 6 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

You can develop naturally, but the pressure against d4 and the possibility of ...dxc4 still govern the position.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

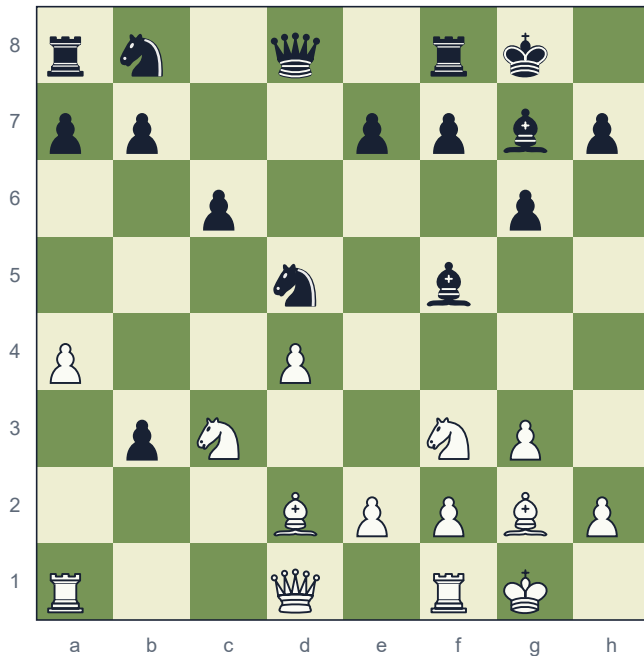
Consider cxd5 if the recapture gives you a useful target. Otherwise keep the center and improve the queen bishop.

WATCH FOR

Do not assume the c6 knight is misplaced simply because it blocks ...c5; it may support an immediate ...e5.

REMEMBER Identify Black's actual central break.

Review before your next game



Main-line study position - White to move

1. IDENTIFY THE STRUCTURE.

Black challenges d4 immediately and often exchanges on c4 or d4. The long diagonals and the c- and d-files become important.

2. NAME BLACK'S PLAN.

Black wants active pieces, ...c5, and pressure against a central pawn that White advances too far. Capturing c4 can buy time for development.

3. CHOOSE YOUR NEXT JOB.

Develop e3 or a queen move to recover c4 as appropriate. Keep your pieces coordinated against ...c5 or ...Na6-b4.

RECONSTRUCTION DRILL

Set up the starting position and play the main study line without looking. After each Black move, say what changed. If you cannot explain your reply, stop at that position and review the relevant line page.

DECISION DRILL

Return to the diagram. Write two candidate moves and a likely reply to each. You are not trying to guess the next engine move: you are testing whether your choices fit the structure and survive checks, captures and threats.

SELF-CHECK

Can you identify every capture and recapture in the line? Can you state one move-order exception? Can you explain the final position without using the opening name?

Related practice: Booklet 24. Use the matching line ID in the PGN companion. Opening names: Lichess public opening dataset; original course choices and analysis, checked with Stockfish 18.